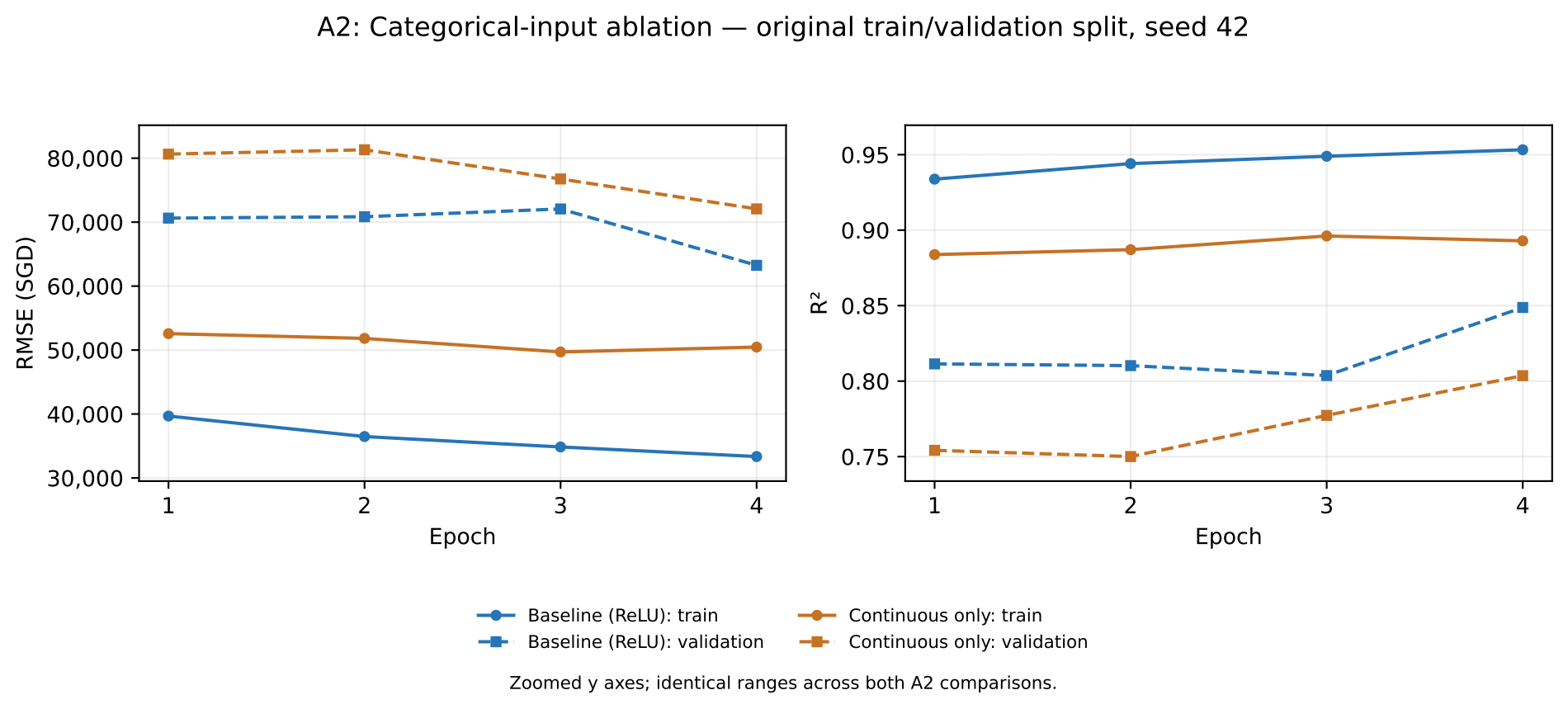
A2: Categorical-input ablation — original train/validation split, seed 42
RMSE (SGD)
80,000
70,000
60,000
50,000
40,000
30,000
1
2
3
4
Epoch
R²
0.95
0.90
0.85
0.80
0.75
1
2
3
4
Epoch
Baseline (ReLU): train
Baseline (ReLU): validation
Continuous only: train
Continuous only: validation
Zoomed y axes; identical ranges across both A2 comparisons.